

WREXHAM GLYNDWR UNIVERSITY: EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES GUIDANCE

If you have experienced unexpected events which have occurred which may have had a significant impact upon your academic performance at the point of assessment, you may be able to submit a claim for extenuating circumstances.

WHAT ARE EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES?

The University defines extenuating circumstances as

'...circumstances, normally exceptional and outside the control of the student, which have prevented him/her from performing in assessment at the level expected or required of him/her or from undertaking the assessment.'

WHO CAN APPLY FOR EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES?

All students who are studying for a qualification awarded by Wrexham Glyndwr University can apply for extenuating circumstances. This comprises undergraduate and postgraduate students who are registered on taught programmes or taught elements of research programmes.

WHEN DO I APPLY EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES?

All applications for extenuating circumstances need to be made within ten working days of your affected assessment deadline.

If you have had an extension to deadline agreed, then you will have ten working days from the agreed extended deadline.

If your marks have been presented to an Assessment Board, then you will not be able to submit a claim for ECs. However, you may be able to submit an Academic Appeal: Request for a Review of an Assessment Board Decision Form.

HOW DO I APPLY FOR EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES?

If you wish to submit an EC claim then you will need to submit an EC1 form - emails and letters requesting extenuating circumstances will not be accepted.

You will also need to supply supporting evidence with your claim; this is because your claim is presented to an independent Panel who do not know you or your circumstances. The Panel can only consider information relating to you – if the evidence provided refers to third parties such as spouses, children (up to the age of 13) or siblings then the evidence will be shredded immediately as the University cannot process this data without an individual's consent.

This Panel will make a decision based solely upon the information you provide in your extenuating circumstances form and the supporting evidence supplied with it. Therefore it is important that you make sure you complete all information accurately. You will need to make sure that the evidence relates to your situation and is timely with the dates of submission. The Panel will consider the dates of your evidence against the submission dates and make a decision based upon this information.

All evidence will need to be provided in either English or Welsh. If you wish to supply evidence which is in a language other than English or Welsh then you will need to have this translated professionally and verified; any costs incurred by translation will be met by you.

Normally a claim must be made by you, your form should not be completed by a tutor or external party. Guidance is available from the Student & Programmes Centre on the exceptional circumstances when submission by a staff member on your behalf is permitted.

WHAT HAPPENS ONCE I SUBMIT MY CLAIM?

Once you have submitted a claim form to the SPC Desk, your case is passed to the Secretary to the Panel for processing. The Secretary will acknowledge your claim and prepare your paperwork for the meeting. If you have not supplied any evidence, the Secretary will contact you and advise you that although your claim has been submitted it cannot be considered without evidence.

Your claim is then presented to the EC Panel; the Panel are made up of academic staff at the University who will consider your claim against the evidence provided. The EC Panel are completely independent and nobody who knows you will consider your case. Therefore it is important that you provide as much information as possible in your claim form.

Following the meeting, the Secretary will write to you to advise you of the Panel's decision.

WHAT ARE THE OUTCOMES FROM THE EC PANEL?

The EC Panel review all claims and decide whether the claim should be accepted, partly accepted or rejected.

Accepted	If your claim is upheld then you will be awarded a deferral. This means that any marks you have received for the work will be reverted to 0 and you will be given the opportunity to resubmit the work at the next available opportunity. The University's Assessment Board will determine when this opportunity will be.
Partly accepted	This occurs when the Panel decide that the evidence provided covers the submission dates for some elements but not all. You will be awarded a deferral for elements where the EC Panel have accepted your claim. Any marks you have received for a piece of work will stand for elements where your claim has been rejected. You are able to submit an appeal against the decision to reject your claim for certain modules but there are limited grounds on which you can appeal.
Rejected	If your claim has been rejected then this means that any marks you have received for a piece of work stand. You are able to submit an appeal against the decision to reject your claim but there are limited grounds on which you can appeal.

GUIDANCE ON SITUATIONS NORMALLY CONSIDERED AS EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES AND EVIDENCE REQUIRED TO SUPPORT YOUR CLAIM

It is your responsibility to provide appropriate evidence with your extenuating circumstances. It is also important that your evidence is about you and relates to the impact upon you. If your extenuating circumstance relates to a health condition, then you should provide supporting evidence which has been written by a qualified medical practitioner who is registered with an appropriate professional body. The secretary will shred any information relating to other individuals you provide as the Panel will not be permitted to review this information due to Data Protection Legislation.

Please note that the Panel will not contact medical practitioners or third parties directly to discuss your case, therefore please do not provide telephone numbers of third parties or advise that letters can be provided if necessary.

The table below shows examples of what will normally be considered as an extenuating circumstance; this table is there for guidance purposes and does not list all possible grounds for ECs. If you are unsure whether your situation would be considered as extenuating circumstances you should contact the Student & Campus Life department or the Students' Union Advice Centre.

Circumstance	Evidence	Sources of support available at the University
Serious illness suffered immediately prior to or during the period of assessment	Doctor's letter which is timely with the date of assessment Copy of prescriptions	Student & Campus Life: Student Information Desk ask@glyndwr.ac.uk Tel: 01978 294421 Students' Union Advice Centre: suadvice@glyndwr.ac.uk Tel: 01978 293371
Serious illness suffered during a period of teaching/learning which has affected your ability to be assessed at the appropriate time	Doctor's letter which is timely with the date of assessment Copy of prescriptions	
Pregnancy – where you are suffering from pregnancy related illness	Letter from GP or midwife	

Circumstance	Evidence	Sources of support available at the University
Death of someone close to you - Where you have lost someone at the assessment time or earlier in the academic year. Someone close to you includes close family members but also friends if you can demonstrate that you had a close relationship with them	Copy of the death certificate Copy of an order of service	Personal Tutors: All students have a personal tutor who is there as a first point for contact to provide pastoral and academic support throughout your time at University. If you are unsure about who your tutor is then you should contact your programme leader or the Student & Programmes Centre.
Serious illness or accident affecting someone close to you	Letter from medical practitioner advising of the impact upon you rather than the circumstances of the individual affected	
Unexpected family commitment outside your control – such as loss of child care where the child is under 13 years old when you are required to attend an assessment	Letter from appropriate independent body, such as childcare provider/school/employer/medical practitioner advising of situation	
Change in personal circumstances or other serious unforeseen event – such as divorce, fire or burglary, severe accommodation issues	Letter from appropriate independent body such as solicitor, police, fire brigade landlord	
Late diagnosis of specific learning difference – this is only applicable when the diagnosis has been made too late for reasonable adjustments to be implemented by the University		
Change in work requirements for part-time students	Letter from employer advising of the change in requirements	Please contact the Inclusion Services Team for advice regarding late diagnosis. Inclusion@glyndwr.ac.uk Tel: 01978 293266

WHAT IS NOT NORMALLY CONSIDERED TO BE AN EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCE?

Below is a list of examples of situations which are not normally considered to be extenuating circumstances:

- Holidays
- A permanent condition which you have already told the University about
- Minor illness such as a cough or cold
- Poor time management
- Misreading the examination timetable
- Routine traffic issues such as heavy traffic or a delayed train
- Computer problems.

Where a situation will occur which affects the whole student body or a whole cohort, the University will resolve these matters centrally to ensure that all students are treated equitably.

HOW DO I SUBMIT AN EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES APPEAL?

If you wish to submit an appeal, you will need to complete an Extenuating Circumstances Appeal Form (EC6 form) available on the MyUni portal. You will also need to supply further independent evidence to support your claim.

Appeals will only be accepted where the appeal is based upon both of the following grounds:

- New evidence in support of your claim has been provided **AND**
- You can show good reason why this evidence was not made available to the Panel before its meeting.

An appeal should be sent in full to the SPC and received no later than ten days after the date of the email advising you of the EC Panel's decision to reject your claim.

WHERE IS MY CLAIM FORM, EVIDENCE OR APPEAL KEPT?

Your claim form and supporting evidence is kept in a locked cabinet in the SPC Office. Only a limited number of staff have access to the key to ensure that your data is kept securely.

If you wish to have your evidence returned to you, you should notify the Secretary of the Panel and provide a stamped address envelope with your claim form.

After the final Assessment Board of that academic year held in September, the SPC Assessment Team will destroy all evidence relating to your claim and your form (without the evidence) will be added to your student file.

WHERE CAN I GET FURTHER ADVICE OR INFORMATION ABOUT EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES?

Students & Programmes Centre	assessments@glyndwr.ac.uk
Student & Campus Life	ask@glyndwr.ac.uk
Students' Union	union@glyndwr.ac.uk
Personal Tutor	

PROCESS FOR SUBMITTING AN EXTENUATING CIRCUMSTANCES CLAIM

